

The AI Food Chain: Who Builds, Who Uses, Who Watches

AI Producers

Build frontier models

USA

OpenAI · Anthropic · Google · Meta

China

ByteDance · Alibaba · DeepSeek · Baidu

UK (DeepMind)

France (Mistral)

Second tier, far smaller than US/China

AI Consumers

Use models others built

Japan · Korea · Germany

Canada · Australia · Israel

Nordics · Singapore

Special cases:

TSMC — hardware producer, not model maker

UAE/Saudi — consumers buying their way up

AI Bystanders

Waiting, or unable to join

Most of Africa · Central Asia

Parts of SE Asia · Pacific islands

Parts of Latin America

Risk: as value shifts from labour to compute,
no AI capability = no seat at the table

Producers want to stay ahead · Consumers want access · Bystanders fear being left behind — misaligned from second one